Springer Protocols Manuscript Instructions

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LENGTH

For editors: The ideal length of your manuscript is specified in your contract. This page count includes references, tables and figure legends.

For authors: Please consult with your editor for the appropriate length of your chapter, and number of figures. Chapters tend to average between 15-30 typed pages (not including images, tables, and references), but there is no limit on length of chapter or number of figures to be included. **Please submit your chapter to the volume editor and not directly to Springer.**

MANUSCRIPT PREPARATION TOOLS – WORD AND LATEX

If you are using Microsoft Word to prepare your manuscript, you do not need to use any special tool for preparation. Please just ensure that the document is clearly structured visually, (e.g., using heading styles, lists, footnotes, etc.).

For LaTeX users, Springer Nature provides an optional manuscript preparation tool that helps structure the manuscript (e.g., define the heading hierarchy). Predefined style formats are available for all the necessary structures that are supposed to be part of the manuscript, and these formats can be quickly accessed via hotkeys or special toolbars.

LaTeX2e macro packages for contributed books.

FORMATTING

For authors and editors:

Chapter Guidelines:

The purpose of this series is to provide individual volumes that describe detailed practical procedures for a particular subject area. Although the research literature contains descriptions of practical procedures, extensive practical detail is not always presented, and, more particularly, an idea of the problems that can be encountered and how they are identified and overcome is rarely included. This series aims to address these deficiencies. Each chapter in a volume of this series should therefore be one specific method, written such that a competent scientist who is unfamiliar with the method can carry out the technique successfully at the first attempt by simply following the detailed practical procedures that you have described. The success of the series is, in large part, due to the usefulness of the "Notes" section. Chapters tend to average 15-30 double-spaced typed pages, but can be longer or shorter as necessary. Wet-lab protocols must be written in the format described below (***A Sample Chapter is included as a reference)***

**Non wet-lab chapters such as reviews, bioinformatics chapters, and methods that don't can't follow the formalized style below can be submitted in whatever format the author wishes.

Please arrange your chapter text file in the following order [For *Methods in Molecular Biology* books only]:

i. Chapter Title

ii. Summary/Abstract

- Begin each chapter with an abstract that summarizes the content and provides a brief overview of the method in no more than 200 words.
- Chapter abstracts significantly increase a book's visibility. Good abstracts will mean that more people read your book. These will appear online at SpringerLink and other sites (such as PubMed and Scopus) and will be available with unrestricted access to facilitate online searching (using Google, for example) and allow unregistered users to read the abstract as a teaser for the complete chapter.

iii. Key Words

- We allow 5–10 keywords per chapter.
- Each keyword should not contain more than two compound words, and each keyword phrase should start with an uppercase letter.
- When selecting the keywords, think of them as terms that will help someone locate your chapter at the top of the search engine list using, for example, Google. Very broad terms, (e.g., "Case study" by itself) should be avoided as these will result in thousands of search results but will not result in finding your chapter.

1. Introduction

This section should contain a summary of, and the outline of any theory to, the method that you are describing. It should also outline the major procedures involved in the protocol.

2. Materials

This section should list the composition of all buffers, media, solutions, and specialist equipment etc., that are necessary for carrying out the method described in section 3. Suppliers aren't needed for routine reagents (the reader will use his/her own local supplier) and catalogue numbers aren't required at all for reagents. All buffers, solutions and media should be presented in the same format i.e. name, colon then composition on one continuous line, with components separated by commas not semi-colons. Do not list individual reagents, but do describe the composition of the solutions, etc they are used in.

3. Methods

This is the main section and should explain in detail the individual steps necessary to carry out the technique. Where possible, please simply list the steps in numerical order. For techniques that comprise a number of separate major procedures, please indicate these separate procedures in the introduction, and then subdivide section 3 into subheadings to cover each procedure (3.1, 3.2 etc). The steps in each subsection should then be numbered individually, renumbering from number one. Do take great care to try to indicate any little "tricks" or nuances that help improve your method by referring to relevant "notes" in section 4 (see below). This sort of information rarely gets into the scientific literature. You may also find it useful to relate to some aspects of the theory in this section indicating the purpose of some of the major steps by cross-referencing to an appropriate “note”. Do not be tempted to get involved in the description of variations/alternatives to your technique in this section: this can be done in the "Notes" section. Stick to the basic procedure detailed in this section.
This section must be comprehensive. Do not send the reader away to find information for a particular step in another reference. All relevant practical detail must be given in this section.

4. Notes

As we all know, even the simplest techniques go wrong from time to time. Would you therefore indicate any major problems or faults that can occur with your technique? Try to indicate the major sources of problems and how they can be identified and overcome. With reference to related techniques, any variations of the technique that you have described should also be made in this section, as well as--where relevant--an indication of the sensitivity of the method, timescale for the singled technique, etc. This "Notes" section is a hallmark of this series and has been singled out for praise by a number of reviewers. Please try and make this section as extensive as possible by putting on paper all of your various experiences with the technique. Each ‘Note’ should be cross-referenced with the ‘Materials’ and ‘Methods’ sections, e.g. (*see* **Note 1**).

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(1) *This study was funded by* [X] [grant number X].
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7. Figure Captions/Table Captions/Tables

8. Figures:
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Please make sure all figures are referenced in the text. All figures will be placed on or near to the page on which they are referenced.

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8.	**Book chapter**	Brown B, Aaron M (2001) The politics of nature. In: Smith J (ed) The rise of modern genomics, 3rd edn. Wiley, New York
9.	**Book, authored**	South J, Blass B (2001) The future of modern genomics. Blackwell, London
10.	**Book, edited**	Smith J, Brown B (eds) (2001) The demise of modern genomics. Blackwell, London

Number	Type	Example
11.	**Book, also showing a translated edition [Either edition may be listed first.]**	Adorno TW (1966) Negative Dialektik. Suhrkamp, Frankfurt. English edition: Adorno TW (1973) Negative Dialectics (trans: Ashton EB). Routledge, London
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13.	**Chapter in a book in a series with volume titles**	Smith SE (1976) Neuromuscular blocking drugs in man. In: Zaimis E (ed) Neuromuscular junction. Handbook of experimental pharmacology, vol 42. Springer, Heidelberg, pp 593–660
14	**OnlineFirst chapter in a series (without a volume designation but with a DOI)**	Saito Y, Hyuga H (2007) Rate equation approaches to amplification of enantiomeric excess and chiral symmetry breaking. Top Curr Chem. doi:10.1007/128_2006_108
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18.	**Paper presented at a conference**	Chung S-T, Morris RL (1978) Isolation and characterization of plasmid deoxyribonucleic acid from Streptomyces fradiae. Paper presented at the 3rd international symposium on the genetics of industrial microorganisms, University of Wisconsin, Madison, 4–9 June 1978
19.	**Patent. Name and date of patent are optional**	Norman LO (1998) Lightning rods. US Patent 4,379,752, 9 Sept 1998
20.	**Dissertation**	Trent JW (1975) Experimental acute renal failure. Dissertation, University of California
21.	**Institutional author (book)**	International Anatomical Nomenclature Committee (1966) Nomina anatomica. Excerpta Medica, Amsterdam
22.	**Non-English, Latin alphabet publication cited in an English publication. NB: Use the language of the primary document, not that of the reference for "vol" etc.!**	Wolf GH, Lehman P-F (1976) Atlas der Anatomie, vol 4/3, 4th edn. Fischer, Berlin
23.	**Non-Latin alphabet publication cited in an**	Marikhin VY, Myasnikova LP (1977) Nadmolekulyarnaya struktura polimerov (The

Number	Type	Example
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27.	**Supplementary material/private homepage**	Doe J (2000) Title of supplementary material. http://www.privatehomepage.com. Accessed 22 Feb 2000
28.	**University site**	Doe J (1999) Title of preprint. http://www.uni-heidelberg.de/mydata.html. Accessed 25 Dec 1999
29.	**FTP site**	Doe J (1999) Trivial HTTP, RFC2169. ftp://ftp.isi.edu/in-notes/rfc2169.txt. Accessed 12 Nov 1999
30.	**Organization site**	ISSN International Centre (2006) The ISSN register. http://www.issn.org. Accessed 20 Feb 2007

In the text:

Number all references in order of use throughout the chapter, and indicate the reference by placing the number of the reference in bold, italicized parenthesis, like this ***(6)***. All references are to be indicated like that ***(7)*** and should appear in numerical order throughout the text ***(8)***.

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- Give each table a caption. Add a reference citation to the table source at the end of the caption, if necessary.
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Chapter name	Graphic Label/Name	Caption (if available)	Alternative Text
Chapter_1.docx	Figure 1	Transliteracy model: the three information cultures (Source: Frau-Meigs, 2013)	A transliteracy model represents the main components covered under info media, info data, and info docs. These are influenced by social and pedagogical uses within and outside school.
Chapter_1.docx	Fig2.eps	--	An error-grouped bar graph plots the mean total correct versus pre and post-test and represents 4 languages, namely, Spanish, French, Romanian, and Swedish.

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